

Agents’ masks add layer of fear

Critics say the tactic imperils citizens as well as immigrants without legal status.

By Jenny Jarvie

For many Angelenos, the spectacle of armed federal agents — faces hidden behind neck gaiters and balaclavas — jumping out of unmarked vans to snatch people off the streets presents a clear threat to public safety.

As federal immigration agents have ratcheted up enforcement raids, arresting and detaining anyone they suspect of violating immigration laws, critics warn that their tactic of masking — particularly when wearing plain clothes and no visible marker of identity — spreads fear and panic across communities and imperils citizens as well as immigrants without legal status.

“It’s very dangerous,” said Scott Shuchart, who worked for U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement from 2022 until January of this year as an assistant director for regulatory affairs and a policy counselor.

“If somebody comes up to you with a mask and a T-shirt and no badge, why would you think that they are exercising a legitimate authority, as opposed to being a violent criminal trying to do you harm?” Shuchart said. “How do you know that you need to not resist to avoid arrest, as opposed to resist arrest to possibly survive the encounter?”

But defenders of federal immigration agents also cite security as a reason for masking.

They present immigrants without legal papers as a threat to public safety, even though the majority of people ICE arrested across L.A. in early June had no criminal record. They also argue that masking is necessary because a convergence of factors — supercharged political rhetoric, more sophisticated facial recognition technology, and increased threat of doxxing on social media — makes the job more dangerous for agents in the field.

“We have a lot of agents whose faces are being put on social media platforms across the country,” said Mathew Silverman, national president of the Federal Law Enforcement Officers Assn. “We have politicians right now that are saying, ‘We will

[See Masks, A8]



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

GOV. GAVIN NEWSOM says that fire funding is a nonpartisan issue and that all states are “in this together.”

Newsom seeks more fire aid

Governor makes request while criticizing Trump over ICE raids

By Laura J. Nelson and Taryn Luna

Gov. Gavin Newsom on Monday marked the six-month anniversary of the Eaton and Palisades fires with a call for billions in federal funding to support the state’s wildfire recovery, and offered a blistering critique of the Trump administration’s most recent immigration raids in MacArthur Park in Los Angeles.

So far, the GOP-led U.S. House of Representatives has made no progress on a

request from Newsom, made in late February, for \$40 billion in additional wildfire funding that would go toward rebuilding schools, churches, homes and hospitals.

Newsom said that fire funding is a nonpartisan issue, and that all U.S. states are “in this together.” He said that other states have outstanding requests for federal aid after their own natural disasters, and that the Republican-controlled House will “absolutely” come through. He urged federal lawmakers to do the

same for Texas after last week’s deadly floods.

“South Carolina, I think they should get every penny that they need,” Newsom said. “North Carolina, they should get every penny that they need. ... I expect that we will figure out a path, a bipartisan path, to support the people of the United States of America, and those include the 40 million Americans residing in California.”

But once again he found himself in the conflicting position of criticizing Republicans while asking them for disaster aid.

Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass had been scheduled to appear at the event, held at Pasadena City College, but did not attend after heavily armed federal immigration agents on horseback descended on MacArthur Park.

Newsom said the immigration raids were proof of President Trump’s “polluted heart,” a shift from the weeks after the fires when he tried to strike a more conciliatory tone as he pushed for more federal aid from Congress and the White House.

[See Newsom, A14]

California not immune to flood risk

Although the state has more safeguards, experts say it is still vulnerable to water disasters.

By Ian James

The deadly flash flood along Texas’ Guadalupe River showed the devastating toll such a disaster can take, and California could face similar dangers when extreme weather strikes.

Low-lying areas along rivers and creeks can be hazardous when downpours and torrents come, as shown by past floods in parts of the state including the Los Angeles area, the Central Valley and the Central Coast.

When a series of extreme winter storms hit California in 2023, about two dozen people died statewide, including some who were swept away by floodwaters and others who were killed by a rock slide, falling trees or car crashes.

“Those risks exist here,” said Brett

[See Flood risk, A6]



AL SEIB Los Angeles Times

CREWS clear debris near Montecito Creek after a landslide in 2018.

Texas toll: Over 100 died in flash floods over holiday weekend. NATION, A6

In Mexico City, anger spills out over gentrification



FERNANDO LLANO Associated Press

DEMONSTRATORS protest on Friday against gentrification in Mexico City.

By Kate Linthicum, Cecilia Sánchez Vidal and Patrick J. McDonnell

MEXICO CITY — Since the early days of the pandemic, foreigners have flooded Mexico City, particularly Americans and Europeans drawn by the cost of living and possibilities of remote work.

During that time, several neighborhoods in the city center have transformed, with tortillerías, corner stores and barbershops replaced by wine bars, cafes and Pilates studios, many of which advertise in English. Rents have soared, and some locals have been priced out of their homes.

Some blame the city’s housing crunch and rising costs on the new arrivals —

and the more than 35,000 Airbnbs operating here.

In recent days, that anger spilled into the streets.

A march against gentrification drew hundreds of people, with protesters holding signs that said “gringo go home,” and demanding that Mexican leaders curb short-term rentals and tax foreigners.

It was held on July 4 — U.S. Independence Day — and was advertised as a protest against “American imperialism.”

The march, which passed the U.S. Embassy, was mostly peaceful. But later, some marchers turned to vandalism, smashing windows of more than a dozen storefronts, including a bank, a popular taco chain and a Starbucks.

Videos showed pro-

[See Protests, A4]

TRUMP’S TARIFFS ON ASIA RATTLE MARKET

Japan, South Korea and others will face 25% import duties starting next month.

By Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — President Trump’s decision to hike tariffs once again on some of America’s largest trading partners rattled markets on Monday, dashing hopes on Wall Street that the White House would cut any significant trade deals, as it had promised, by the middle of this week.

In a series of letters sent to foreign leaders, and promptly posted by the president to his social media platform, Trump said the new rates amount to the cost of doing business with “the extraordinary Economy of the United States, The Number One Market in the World, by far.” Under the new policy, Japan, South Korea, Malaysia and Kazakhstan will face 25% import duties starting Aug. 1, while goods from Cambodia and Thailand are set for 36% tariffs. Laos and Myanmar will face a 40% rate, according to the letters.

Indonesia faces a 32% duty. Bangladesh and Serbia were told their goods would face 35% import rates, and goods from South Africa and Bosnia and Herzegovina sent to the United States would face duties of 30%.

“It is a Great Honor for me to send you this letter in that it demonstrates the strength and commitment of our Trading Relationship,” Trump wrote in the letters, sending the same text to each foreign leader.

Markets recoiled at the news, with the Dow Jones industrial average dropping 1.4%, the Nasdaq falling 1.2%

[See Tariffs, A11]

Cuts to healthcare go beyond Medicaid

By Phil Willon

SACRAMENTO — The federal safety-net health-care system for low-income and disabled Americans, Medicaid, won’t be the only medical coverage devastated by the package of spending cuts and tax breaks signed into law by President Trump on the Fourth of July.

Covered California, the state’s Affordable Care Act health insurance marketplace, estimates that as many as 660,000 of the roughly 2 million people in the program will either be stripped of coverage or drop out because of increased cost and the onerous new mandates to stay enrolled. Those who do stay could be hit with an average monthly premium increase of up to 66%.

According to estimates by the nonpartisan Congressional Budget Office, the Republican-led package approved by Congress last week will lead to 11.8 million more people going without health insurance nationwide over the next decade.

Covered California serves as a marketplace exchange for state residents seeking healthcare insurance under the federal Affordable Care Act, widely known as Obamacare, allowing them to select from name-brand insurance pro-

[See Healthcare, A14]

Extreme heat poses challenge

High temperatures and wildfires imperil the health and well-being of children. LEARNING, A9

Raid targets MacArthur Park

Agents on horseback and in armored vehicles descend on immigrant enclave. CALIFORNIA, B1

Is pitcher Ohtani hurting his bat?

Dodgers star has looked good on the mound, but stats hint at a decline offensively. SPORTS, B10

Weather

Turning sunny. L.A. Basin: 87/65. B6

Markets

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